Make Gordonston Great Again

Children-first legacy on Gwinnett Street

Not a political campaign - neighborhood restoration



The neighborhood plan



Make Gordonston Great Again is a neighbor-led plan to restore Juliette Gordon Low's children-first legacy on Gwinnett Street. The name is wordplay on neglect, not a national campaign. Gordonston was built around youth from the start; the buildings and acreage are still here, but today's children face a triple vacancy: Shuman Elementary at 415 Goebel Avenue is permanently closed, so most families commute farther and walk-to-school mornings on this block are gone; Christ's Community Church at 1805 E. Gwinnett still has a large education wing mostly idle on weekdays; and Juliette Gordon Low Park (~seven acres) is often locked behind Residents Only rules left over from a feud that never really finished.

In 2011 the Savannah Morning News documented Twickenham and Gordonston fighting over the park and a tax challenge that likely ended only because neither side could afford the legal fees to finish it. Twickenham children were pushed back at the iron gate; that wound hardened after Shuman closed. SCCPSS remains below state on core reading and writing; a volunteer study hall would be extra help after the bus ride, not a replacement school. The plan welcomes Twickenham in the free zone as repair, not as outsiders asking for a favor.

The working program is a volunteer homework campus: permission to use a few church classrooms and a screen room on days the published calendar is open, with Sunday worship untouched. Help is secular schoolwork only - reading, writing, math, assignments from home or public school - and 100% compatible with Morningside Baptist heritage at the host church: no teaching that Christianity is false, no counter-proselytizing, volunteers as guests under church rules. Cost is free for Gordonston, Twickenham, and nearby blocks. With park trustees' agreement, supervised outdoor blocks can bring children together under posted gate rules - the practical reconciliation the 2011 fight never achieved. Pilot small: one age band, one weekday, grow only if volunteers and families return.

Author proposal in discovery phase - not yet endorsed by church, park trustees, GNA, or SCCPSS. Tell us what you think before anything is pitched formally.

Volunteer or support the plan:

ari@asu.edu

Full article:
paradigmthreat.net/influence/controlled_opposition/make-gordonston-great-again.md